In addition to server-rendered applications, ASP.NET core is ideally suited to building a REST or HTTP API server. Whether you're building a mobile app, a JavaScript SPA using Angular, React, Vue, or some other client-side framework, it's easy to create an ASP.NET Core application to act as the server-side API by using both the minimal API and web API paradigms built into ASP.NET Core. You'll learn about minimal APIs in part 1 and about web APIs in chapter 20.

DEFINITION *REST* stands for *representational state transfer*. RESTful applications typically use lightweight and stateless HTTP calls to read, post (create/ update), and delete data.

ASP.NET Core isn't restricted to creating RESTful services. It's easy to create a web service or remote procedure call (RPC)-style service for your application, using gRPC for example, as shown in figure 2.5. In the simplest case, your application might expose only a single endpoint! ASP.NET Core is perfectly designed for building simple services, thanks to its cross-platform support and lightweight design.

DEFINITION gRPC is a modern open-source, high-performance RPC framework. You can read more at https://grpc.io.

